

Half Hungry

When Niloy was born, his father had a dream in which Bidhata, the god who writes the **destinies** of men, appeared to him.

"Your son," said the god, "will never be able to fully satisfy his hunger. Train him to be satisfied with a minimum of food."

His father tried, but Niloy never succeeded in **overcoming** his love for food, and when he couldn't get enough of it, it made him **miserable**.



The years passed. Niloy married and raised a family, but poverty **dogged his footsteps**, and there was not a day when he could say he had had enough to eat. He always went to bed half hungry.

One day he was invited to the wedding of a rich man's daughter. It made him feel that **perhaps** his luck had changed.

"There will **certainly** be a lot of food at the wedding," he thought. "I'll eat to my heart's **content**."

There was certainly a lot of food at the wedding, but when he had eaten just a little, a heavy decorative piece under which he was sitting fell on him, **rendering** him **unconscious**. When he had recovered, all the food was over.

His host, wanting to **make up for** the distress caused to him, invited him to lunch the next day. When he presented himself at the house the next afternoon, his host instructed his servants to take good care of him and to see that he was well fed.

Bidhata, god of destinies, was **alarmed** when he saw the servants **piling** food **on** the banana leaf from which Niloy was eating. He quickly took the form of a tiny frog and **hopped** onto the leaf, hoping that Niloy would be so filled with **disgust** that he would lose his **appetite**.

What the god did not know was that his victim was extremely **short-sighted**. Niloy **scooped up** the frog along with a ball of rice and **swallowed** it. The god was trapped. His only **consolation** was that Niloy had begun to feel **uneasy** after swallowing him and had stopped eating.

Bidhata **called out** to Niloy while he was returning home and explained his **predicament**.

"**Spit** me out," he **entreated**.

"Spit you out!" **exclaimed** the man when he had got over the shock of hearing a voice from his stomach—and that too of a god. "You have troubled me all my life. Do you think I will let you go so easily!"

"My duty is to write the destinies of men," said the god. "I **derive** no **pleasure** from their **tribulations**."

"Be that as it may," said Niloy. "I will not let you go until you promise to end my **state** of **perpetual** hunger."

"I cannot **alter** anyone's destiny," said Bidhata, "but if you become my **devotee** and worship me in an appropriate manner you will have my blessings."

"One can achieve great things with **divine** blessings," thought Niloy. He forced himself to bring up the food he had eaten, and the frog came out in the process. As Bidhata **assumed** his true form, Niloy said to him:

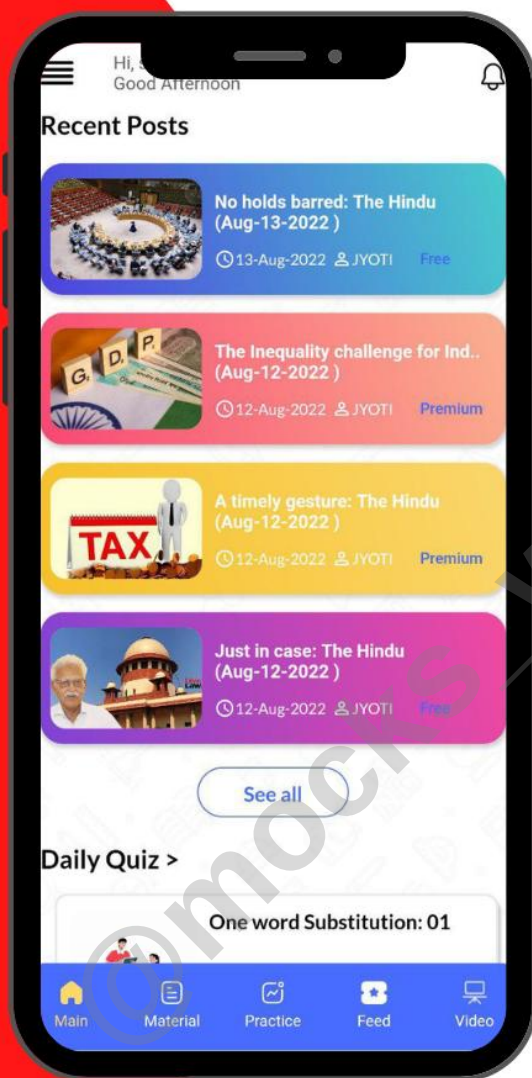
"Now tell me, what is the appropriate way to worship you?"

"In your case," replied Bidhata, "the only way you can worship me is by never fully satisfying your hunger. Remain hungry all the time."

Vocabulary

1. **Destiny** (noun) – Fate, fortune, lot, predestination, kismet भाग्य
2. **Overcome** (verb) – Conquer, defeat, master, prevail over, triumph over काबू पाना
3. **Miserable** (adjective) – Unhappy, wretched, dejected, gloomy, sorrowful दुखी
4. **Dog one's footsteps** (phrase) – Pursue, follow closely, haunt, shadow, tail पीछा करना
5. **Perhaps** (adverb) – Maybe, possibly, conceivably, potentially, perchance शायद
6. **Certainly** (adverb) – Definitely, surely, undoubtedly, unquestionably, clearly निश्चित रूप से
7. **Content** (noun) – Satisfaction, fulfilment, happiness, gratification, pleasure संतोष
8. **Render** (verb) – Make, cause, provide, deliver, present बनाना / कर देना
9. **Unconscious** (adjective) – Insensible, unresponsive, senseless, comatose, unaware बेहोश
10. **Make up for** (phrase) – Compensate, atone, redress, repay, offset भरपाई करना
11. **Alarm** (verb) – Frighten, startle, unnerve, panic, worry डराना
12. **Pile on** (verb) – Heap, load, accumulate, gather, stack इकट्ठा करना / चढ़ाना
13. **Hop** (verb) – Jump, leap, bounce, skip, spring कूदना
14. **Disgust** (adjective) – Revolting, repellent, gross, nauseating, offensive घिनौना
15. **Appetite** (noun) – Hunger, craving, desire, longing, yearning भूख / इच्छा
16. **Short-sighted** (adjective) – Nearsighted, myopic, imprudent, narrow-minded, unseeing दूरदर्शिता से रहित
17. **Scoop up** (phrasal verb) – Pick up, gather, lift, collect, hoist उठाना
18. **Swallow** (verb) – Ingest, gulp, devour, consume, down निगलना
19. **Consolation** (noun) – Comfort, solace, relief, support, reassurance सांत्वना
20. **Uneasy** (adjective) – Anxious, uncomfortable, nervous, restless, troubled बेचैन
21. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – Shout, summon, exclaim, yell, announce पुकारना
22. **Predicament** (noun) – Dilemma, difficulty, mess, bind, quandary संकट
23. **Spit** (verb) – Eject, expel, vomit, discharge, throw out थूकना

24. **Entreat** (verb) – Beg, plead, implore, beseech, request विनती करना
25. **Exclaim** (verb) – Cry out, shout, call out, proclaim, utter चिल्लाना
26. **Derive** (verb) – Obtain, get, draw, extract, acquire प्राप्त करना
27. **Pleasure** (noun) – Delight, joy, satisfaction, happiness, enjoyment आनंद
28. **Tribulation** (noun) – Suffering, distress, hardship, adversity, misery कष्ट
29. **State** (noun) – Condition, situation, status, phase, circumstance स्थिति
30. **Perpetual** (adjective) – Constant, unending, everlasting, eternal, continuous लगातार
31. **Alter** (verb) – Change, modify, adjust, revise, transform बदलना
32. **Devotee** (noun) – Follower, believer, disciple, adherent, worshipper भक्त
33. **Divine** (adjective) – Godly, holy, sacred, heavenly, celestial दिव्य
34. **Assume** (verb) – Adopt, take on, accept, pretend, presume रूप लेना / मान लेना



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